

Humanitarian Response in the Philippines

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News & Events



24 October 2009
UN Family observes UN Day by helping Typhoon survivors

It has been a tradition of the United Nations system in the Philippines to organize a get-together for all UN staff and family to celebrate UN Day on the 24th of October. However, given that there are still many Filipinos affected by the floods and heavy rain, a more modest UN Day celebration was organized.

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22 October 2009
36.1 million Filipinos call for end to poverty

For the second year in a row, the Philippines sent the loudest voice worldwide in calling for an end to extreme poverty, with 36.1 million Filipinos participating in various events during the three-day global Stand Up, Take Action Against Poverty campaign of the United Nations Millennium Campaign (UNMC) last Oct. 16 to 18.

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07 October 2009
Disasters set back efforts to fight poverty

With six years to go before the deadline for the achievement of the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs), the Philippines continues to lag behind on its targets to reduce poverty by year 2015, and the series of natural disasters further threatens development efforts.

The MDGs are eight time-bound goals aimed at significantly reducing, if not completely eradicating, extreme poverty by 2015. Of these goals, the Philippines lags behind its targets on eliminating poverty and hunger, achieving universal primary education, reducing maternal deaths, and combating HIV and AIDS.

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23 September 2009
Ahead of G-20, new figures predict less aid and more debt for poor countries already hit by economic crisis

United Nations Millennium Campaign Warns that Poor Countries Risk Being Left Out of Looming Economic Recovery

Ahead of Friday's G-20 summit in Pittsburgh, the United Nations Millennium Campaign is releasing new figures which show that unless rich countries marshal additional resources at the summit, they are likely to deliver \$33 billion less aid than promised to the poor countries which are hardest hit by the global economic crisis. At the same time, packages intended to help poor countries address the crisis might drive them deeper into debt.

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17 September 2009
High Level ILO Mission to the Philippines on Convention No. 87 Freedom of Association and Right to Organize

A High Level Mission of the International Labour Organization (ILO) will visit the Philippines from 22-29 September 2009 to review matters relating to the application in law and in practice of the Freedom of Association and Protection of the Right to Organize Convention (No. 87), 1948, which the Philippines ratified in 1953.

The Philippines was among 25 cases discussed in 2007 by the International Labour Conference Committee on the Application of Standards (CAS) and, following a number of trade union complaints which had been submitted to the ILO's supervisory bodies, was invited to accept a high level mission. In 2009, the Philippine government accepted the high level mission to identify areas in which the ILO could provide support and technical assistance for effective application of the convention.

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8 September 2009
WFP and BAYO to support children in Mindanao through KC Concepcion's new clothing line

The United Nations World Food Programme (WFP) and its National Ambassador against Hunger, KC Concepcion, are teaming up with BAYO, one of the leading apparel brands in the Philippines, to raise awareness about hunger and to provide tens of thousands of nutritious meals to school children in conflict-affected parts of Central Mindanao.

In her first venture as a fashion designer, KC has created a series of 'hoodies' (hooded sweatshirts) and t-shirts that BAYO will market through the 'YOU' campaign. As a product endorser of BAYO since 2007, KC convinced the company to channel its social responsibility program towards helping WFP fight hunger – and a portion of the sales of the 'YOU' collection will go towards providing school meals to children.

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26 August 2009
PGMA determined to achieve MDG targets

President Gloria Macapagal-Arroyo has directed concerned agencies to develop strategies to attain commitments under the Millennium Development Goals (MDG). The President issued the directive as she welcomed Dr. Jacqueline Badcock, the new United Nations Resident Coordinator and Resident Representative of the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) in the Philippines. At their meeting in Malacañang's Music Room, President Arroyo and Badcock discussed the progress of six of the eight MDG goals and the challenges facing the Philippines and many other countries with regard to universal basic education and maternal mortality rate.

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26 August 2009
WFP distributes rice rations from large Japanese donation to Mindanao

The United Nations World Food Programme (WFP) today began providing thousands of displaced people in Mindanao with vital rice rations thanks to a large donation from the Government of Japan.

At a ceremony in Maguindanao, the Ambassador of Japan to the Philippines, HE Makoto Katsura, and representatives from Philippine government and WFP witnessed the first distributions of rice purchased with the Japanese donation of 455 million Philippine pesos (860 million Japanese yen) to assist people affected by conflict and internal displacement in Mindanao.

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20 August 2009
Anti child porn bill pushed

TARLAC Rep Monica Nikki Prieto Teodoro yesterday urged her colleagues in the Lower House to pass House Bill 6440 or the Anti Child Pornography bill on third reading next week.

She said decisive action on the bill will send a strong signal to pedophiles and child porn Website-makers that government is serious about shutting down their activities for good.

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10 August 2009
UN Expert Commemorates International Day of the World's Indigenous Peoples

"Since assuming my mandate over a year ago, I have witnessed that indigenous peoples continue to face many impediments to the enjoyment of human rights, despite some important advances," said James Anaya, Special Rapporteur on the situation of human rights and fundamental freedoms of indigenous people, on the occasion of the International Day of the World's Indigenous Peoples.

The adoption of the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples in September 2007 by the United Nations General Assembly was a milestone, culminating in two and a half decades of study and discussion. This achievement, among other things, is a testament to the courage and resilience indigenous peoples have displayed in their determination to survive, and demonstrates their relative success in increased recognition on the world stage.

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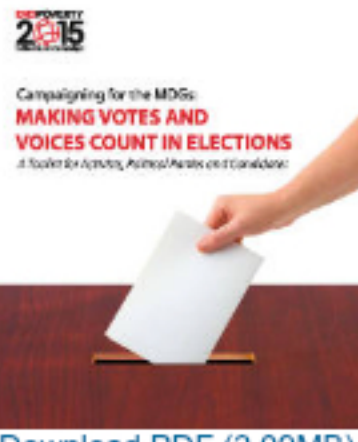
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